The Professional's Prompt Playbook

Twelve prompt patterns you can copy, fill in and use today.

1. Role + Task + Context

You are a [role]. Help me [task]. Context: [who it's for, constraints, tone].

2. Give an example

Here is an example of what good looks like: [example]. Write three more in the same style.

3. Ask for options

Give me 5 different approaches to [problem], with pros and cons for each.

4. Summarise for a reader

Summarise this for a busy [audience] in 5 bullets, then list decisions needed.

5. Critique my draft

Act as a sceptical [reviewer]. List the 5 weakest points in this draft and how to fix them.

6. Structure the output

Return the answer as a table with columns: [A], [B], [C].

7. Step by step

Work through this step by step, then give the final answer on its own line.

8. Interview me first

Before you write anything, ask me up to 5 questions you need answered.

9. Rewrite the tone

Rewrite this to be [warmer / more concise / more formal] without changing the facts.

10. Extract the data

From the text below, extract every [name, date, amount] into a list.

11. Plan a project

Create a week-by-week plan to [goal] with owners, milestones and risks.

12. Check the numbers

Recalculate these figures and flag anything that doesn't add up.